



Data Privacy Policy

PURPOSE

This Data Privacy Policy ensures that MEST processes personal data in a way that is consistent with the United Nations General Assembly's Guidelines for the Regulation of Computerised Personal Data. This policy lays down the rules and principles relating to processing personal data of MEST community members.

MEST is committed to ensuring that your privacy is protected. All personal information asked of you will only be used in accordance with this privacy statement.

WHAT WE COLLECT

In principle, at MEST, we may collect and process personal data of people who visit our website (<https://meltwater.org/>) only to the extent it is required to provide a functioning website as well as for our content and services. The processing of personal data of our users regularly takes place with the users consent. An exception applies in cases where it is not possible to obtain prior consent for factual reasons and where the processing of the data is permitted by law.

This data may include information provided by you:

- at the time of registering to sign up to our Programs or when updating any of the information provided at the time of registering;
- at the time of subscribing to our services or posting material to our sites;
- if you subscribe to any of our mailing lists;
- if you complete any surveys or feedback that we may invite you to participate in; and
- in connection with your other communications with us

The information you give us may include your name, age (within a range), postcode, email address, phone number, gender, ethnicity, religion, disability status, employer, affiliated organizations (e.g. professional body), job details, personal description, information relating to your participation in the Program and your feedback on any of our programs.

As part of the registration process, you will be asked to provide your specific consent for us to process your personal data, including sensitive personal data relating to ethnicity, disability status and/or religion.



WHAT WE DO WITH THE INFORMATION WE GATHER

We will only use your personal data when the law allows us to. We may use personal data that we hold about you in the following ways:

- to administer and facilitate our Programs;
- to contact you in relation to a Program that you have signed up for (including by email, SMS, post or telephone);
- to contact you in relation to our other Programs or Projects (including by email, SMS, post or telephone), if you chose to receive these communications;
- if you register with us to provide you with information (including our newsletter) relating to similar services or projects that we may offer from time to time, provided that you chose this option or subsequently;
- if you provide feedback about our Programs, website, online platforms, services or projects through a contact form or email address, to develop and improve the relevant area;
- if you sign up to receive email updates about the issues discussed on our sites only to provide the service(s) you have requested;
- to monitor the way in which our sites are used, and to ensure that content from our sites is presented in the most effective manner for you and your internet browser;
- in connection with any agreements or other arrangements between you and us (including the Website Terms and Conditions);
- to notify you about changes to our organization or services; and to personalise your experience on our sites.

DISCLOSURE OF INFORMATION ABOUT YOU

Though we do not share any personal data with third parties (e.g. marketing companies) for commercial, marketing or unsolicited communication purposes, we do need to share certain data in order to maximise the MEST's goals of providing inspiration, knowledge and skills to young entrepreneurs across Africa in the aim that their careers and futures are the best they can be.

Some of the information shared are:

- **Information about volunteers:** If you register with us as a volunteer for one of our Programs, we may share your personal information with third parties who are also registered with us in connection with the Program (i.e. Portfolio companies and related organizations) in order to match you with appropriate speaking, governance or other



similar opportunities. If you provide your express consent for us to do so, we may also share your personal information with other professional bodies, networks or associations of which you are a member so that they can contact you about your participation in the Program. Information you provide about disabilities may be used to match you with suitable placements that relate to opportunities for people living with disabilities, and/or information you provide about religion may be used to match you with roles that require people of that particular religion, in each case only if you indicate that you are interested in roles of this nature and are happy for this information to be shared with prospective institutions.

- **Information about Partners:** If you register with us as a partner, we may share some of your personal information (i.e. your name and the name and location of your organization) with third parties who are also registered with us in connection with the Programmes in order to introduce you to potential stakeholders and other volunteers. We will not share your personal contact details, as all contact will be initiated through our website.

DATA PRIVACY AND SECURITY

All information provided to us is stored on a secure cloud-based server provided by a third party vendor. We are committed, however, to ensuring that your information is secure. In order to prevent unauthorized access or disclosure, we have put in place suitable physical, electronic and managerial procedures to safeguard and secure the information we collect online.

Although we will do our best to protect your personal data, we cannot guarantee the security of the information transmitted to our sites. Any transmission will be at your own risk. Once we have received your information, we will use appropriate security features and procedures to try to prevent unauthorised access.

YOUR RIGHTS

You have the right to:

- request access to personal data held about you by us and be provided information in relation to that data (including the purposes for which the data is processed, the recipients to whom that personal data have been or will be disclosed, how long it will be stored for, etc.);



- have inaccurate personal data amended or erased, and to have incomplete personal data completed;
- request the erasure of your personal data (the so-called ‘right to be forgotten’);
- object to or restrict the processing of your personal data (including where your personal data is processed for direct marketing purposes);
- request that your personal data be transferred to another data controller or provided in a format that will permit this transfer (the so-called ‘right to portability’); and
- object to any decision that affects you being taken solely by a computer or other automated process (including profiling);

HOW WE USE COOKIES

A cookie is a small file which asks permission to be placed on your computer's hard drive. Once you agree, the file is added and the cookie helps analyse web traffic or lets you know when you visit a particular site. Cookies allow web applications to respond to you as an individual. The web application can tailor its operations to your needs, likes and dislikes by gathering and remembering information about your preferences.

Like virtually all web sites, we store data on visits in server log files, which contain IP addresses of machines used to access this site, and pages requested.

We use Google Analytics to collect information about how people use this site. We do this to make sure it's meeting its users' needs and to understand how we could do it better.

Google Analytics stores information about what pages you visit, how long you are on the site, how you got here and what you click on. We do not allow Google to use or share our analytics data.

You can choose to accept or decline cookies. Most web browsers automatically accept cookies, but you can usually modify your browser setting to decline cookies if you prefer. This may prevent you from taking full advantage of the website.

LINKS TO OTHER WEBSITES

Our website may contain links to other websites of interest. However, once you have used these links to leave our site, you should note that we may not have control over that other



website. Therefore, we cannot be responsible for the protection and privacy of any information which you provide whilst visiting such sites. Note that such sites are not governed by this privacy statement.